



Feedback form for the course

Please do fill this in before the end of term

We do take comments seriously, and they help to make the course better over time

https://cambridge.eu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_3z0oG7tq3O9xtpc

Waveform tomography

From last time

Using Fermat's principle, we find that:

$$\delta T = - \int_{\text{ray}} \frac{\delta v}{v^2} ds,$$

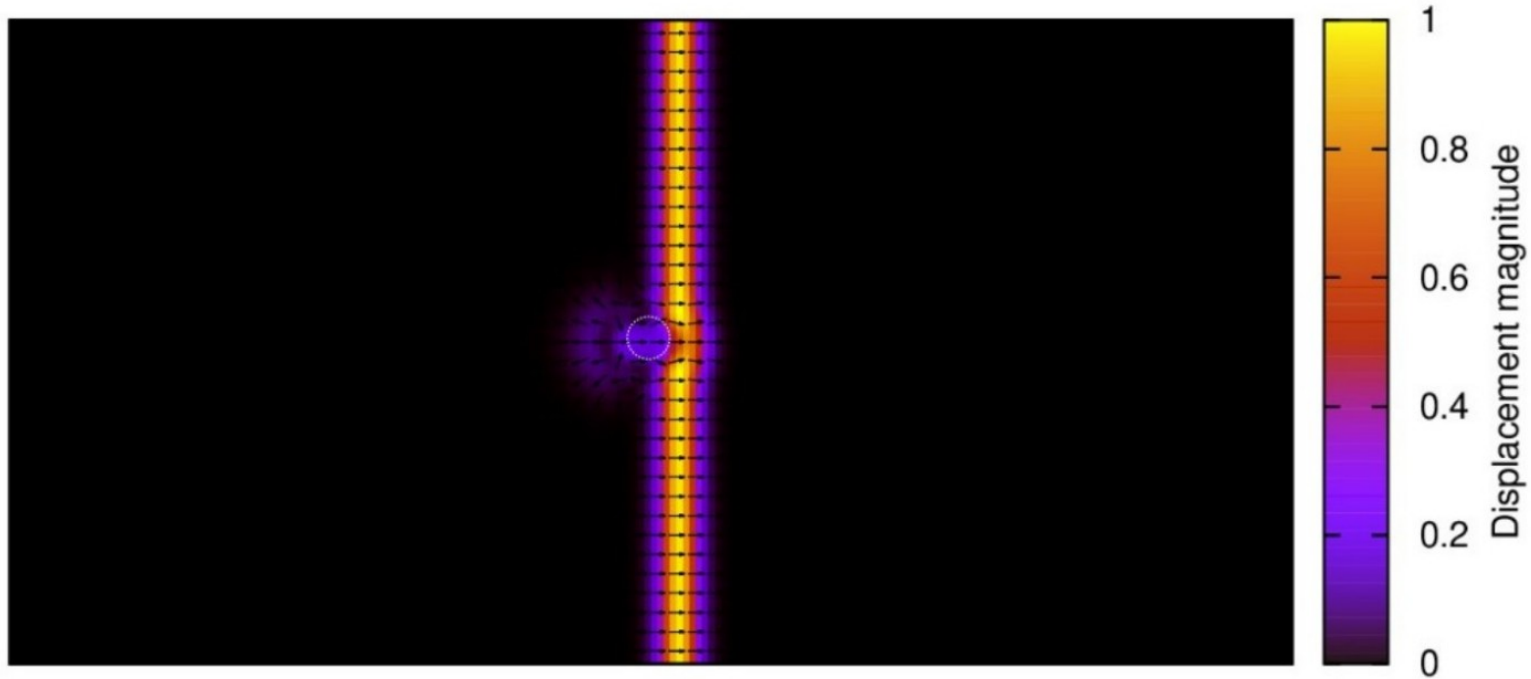
Expand the velocity in a finite-dimensional basis:

$$\delta \alpha(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{j=1}^m \delta \alpha_j \varphi_j(\mathbf{x}).$$

Formulation as a regularised least squares problem:

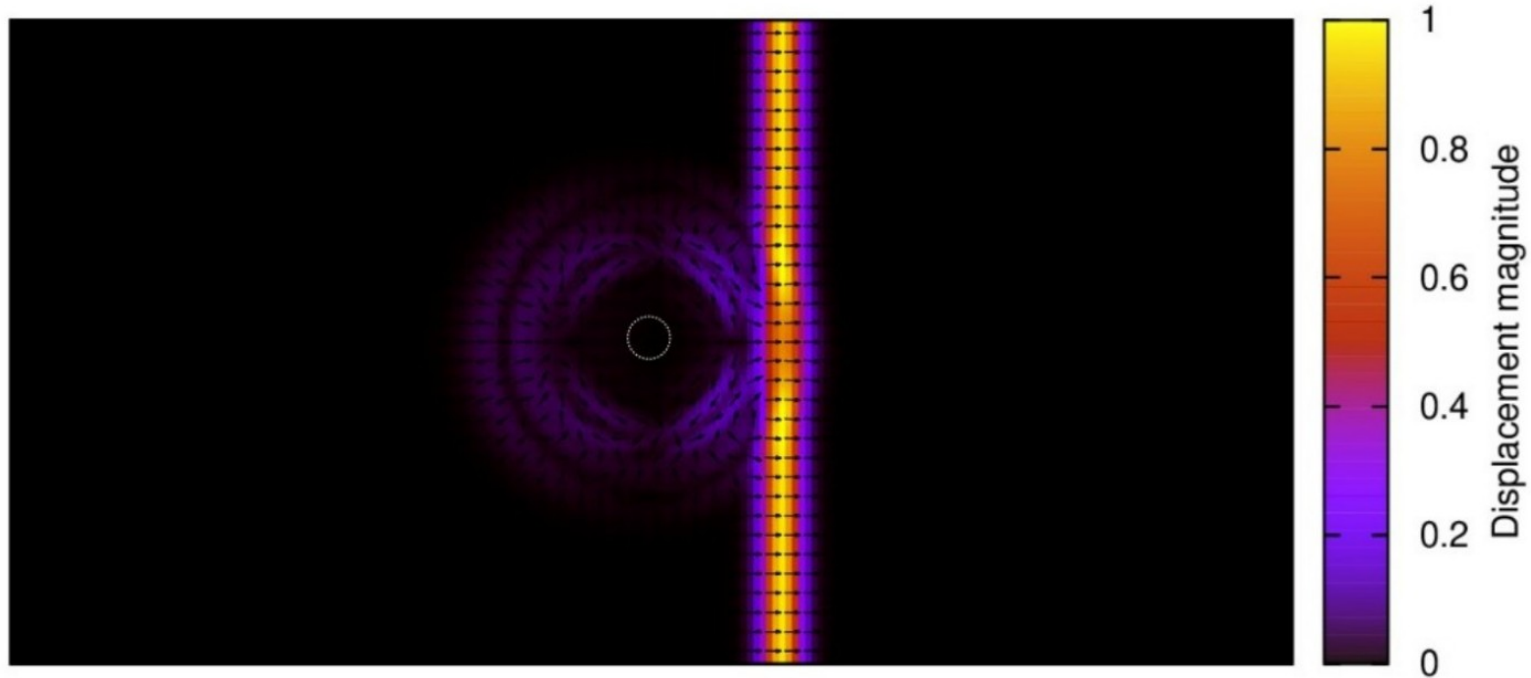
$$J(\mathbf{m}) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{A}\mathbf{m} - \mathbf{d})^T \mathbf{C}^{-1}(\mathbf{A}\mathbf{m} - \mathbf{d}) + \frac{\lambda}{2}(\mathbf{m} - \mathbf{m}_0)^T \mathbf{B}(\mathbf{m} - \mathbf{m}_0),$$

Wavefront healing



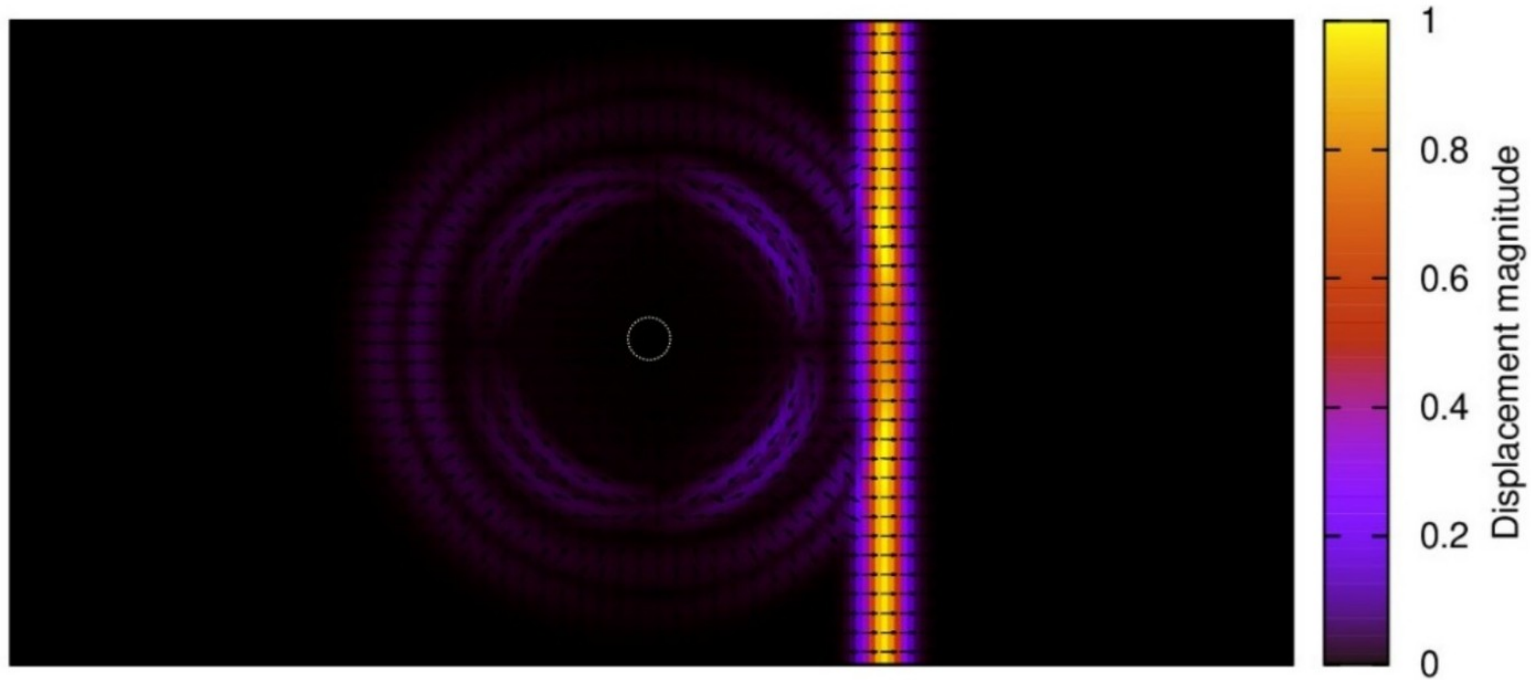
Scattering regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \approx 1$ Geometric optics regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \gg 1$

Wavefront healing



Scattering regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \approx 1$ Geometric optics regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \gg 1$

Wavefront healing

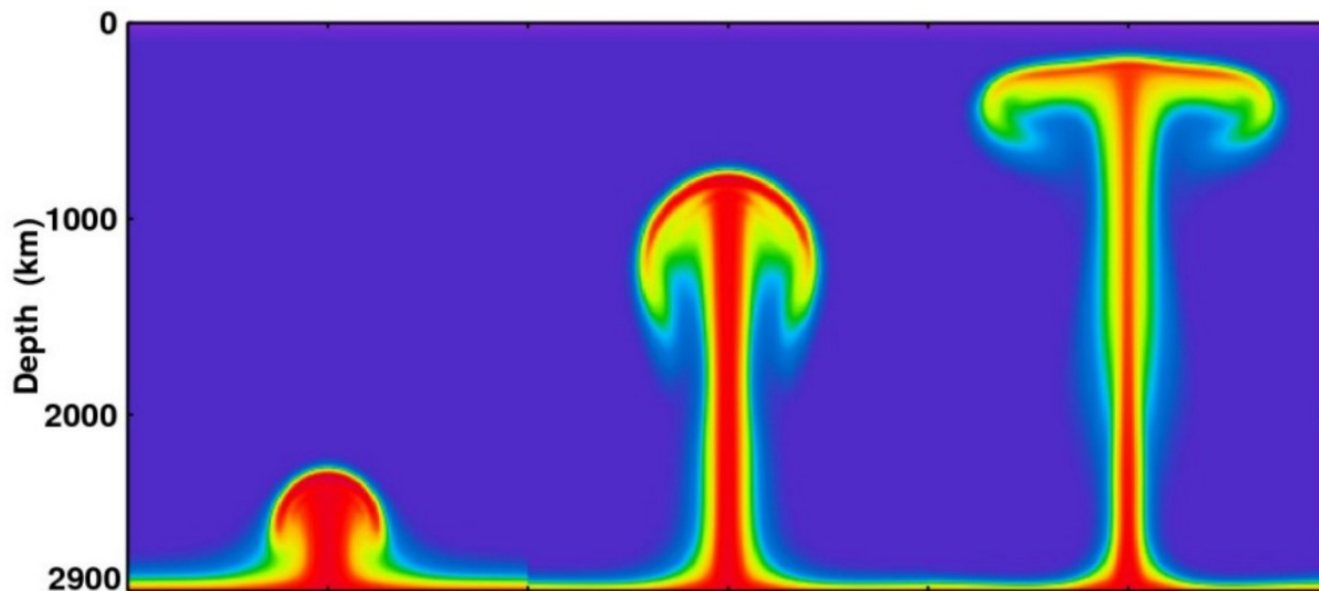


Scattering regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \approx 1$ Geometric optics regime: $\frac{L}{\lambda} \gg 1$

Lengths scales in the mantle

Typical periods for global seismology: 1-40s

Corresponding wavelengths: 10-400km



Farnetani 1997

Waveform inversion

Equations of motion

Equations of motion:

$$\rho \frac{\partial^2 u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) = - \frac{\partial \bar{S}_{ij}}{\partial x_j},$$

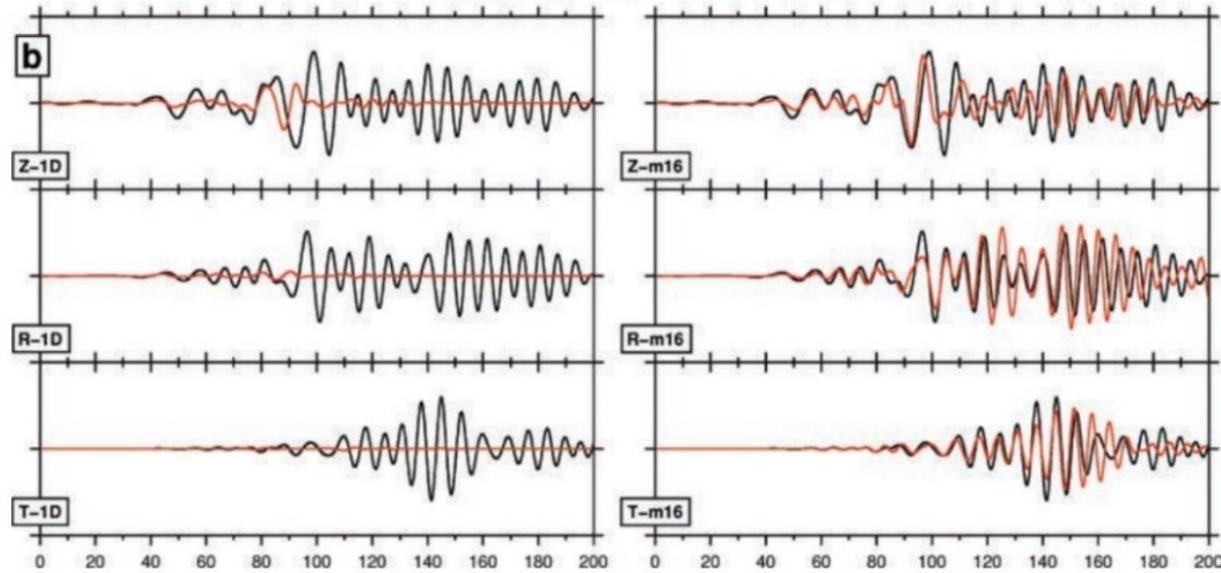
$$A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} \hat{n}_j = \bar{S}_{ij} \hat{n}_j$$

These can be solved numerically in realistic laterally heterogeneous earth models using techniques like the **finite element methods**

These are demanding calculations, run on HPC systems using parallel computing over hundreds or thousands of cores. Applications of GPU computing is common

Each simulation take **tens of minutes to hours** depending on resources

Waveform misfits



Tape et al. 2010

$$J = \frac{1}{2} \int_0^T ||\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - \mathbf{u}^{obs}(t)||^2 dt,$$

Formulation of the problem

Misfit is an implicit function of the parameters in the elastic wave equation:

- 1) **Density** – piecewise constant function
- 2) **Elastic tensor** – piecewise constant tensor field (21 independent components)
- 3) **Stress glut** – space and time dependent tensor field
- 4) **Geometry** of the model (e.g., topography on internal boundaries)

Relation can be condensed to:

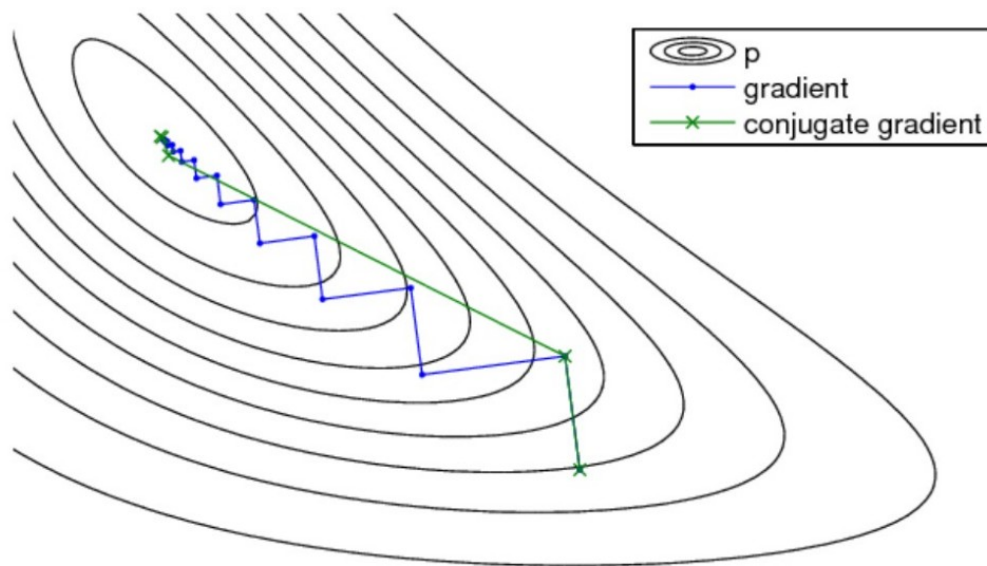
$$\mathbf{m} \mapsto J(\mathbf{m})$$

The aim is to **minimise** this functional

Strictly defined on an **infinite-dimensional space**. In practice reduced to a finite but high-dimensional space linked to the numerical discretisation of the equations of motion

Millions or billions of degrees of freedom would be typical

Gradient based optimisation



Iterative reduction of the misfit using the local gradient to take steps downhill

For large-scale optimisation problems, this is often the only viable approach

Bayesian sampling methods are not typically an option, though this is active research topic

To proceed, we need a way of evaluating the gradients

Functional derivatives

Functional derivative defined through a first-order Taylor expansion:

$$J(\mathbf{m} + \delta\mathbf{m}) = J(\mathbf{m}) + \langle DJ(\mathbf{m}) | \delta\mathbf{m} \rangle + O(||\delta\mathbf{m}||^2),$$

The terms **gradient** and **sensitivity kernel** are equivalent and widely used

Focusing on S-wave velocity variations alone, we can write to first order:

$$\langle DJ(\mathbf{m}) | \delta\mathbf{m} \rangle = \int_M K_\beta \delta\beta d^3\mathbf{x}$$

Methods for calculation will be discussed later

Gradient based optimisation

Condition for a minimum – global and then local:

$$J(\overline{\mathbf{m}} + \delta \mathbf{m}) \geq J(\overline{\mathbf{m}}),$$

$$DJ(\overline{\mathbf{m}}) = \mathbf{0}.$$

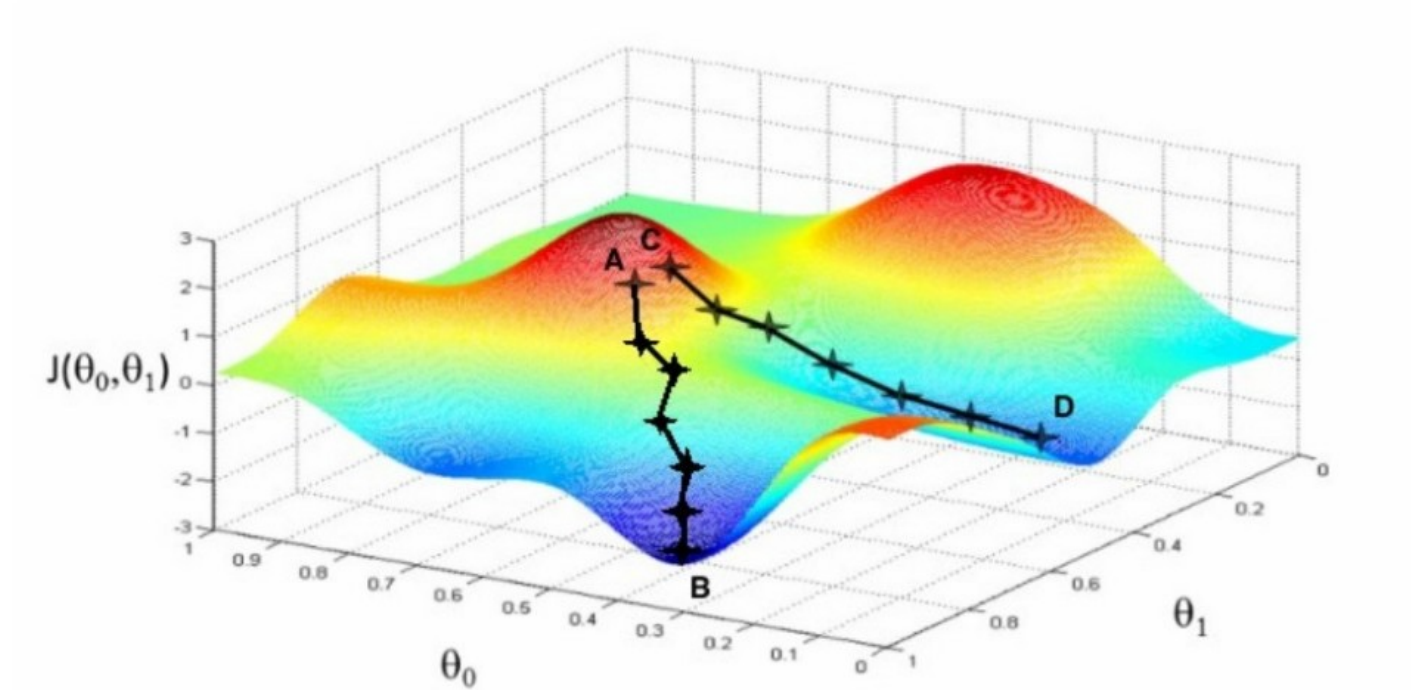
Starting an an initial point, we consider the update:

$$\mathbf{m}_1 = \mathbf{m}_0 - \lambda DJ(\mathbf{m}_0)$$

Step length determined by approximately solving a 1D minimisation problem

Process is repeated until convergence or the misfit is sufficiently small

Local minima



Gradient based methods produce only local minima

Uncertainty quantification possible to a limit extent, but adds significantly to the cost

Calculating the gradients

How not to do it

Finite difference approximation:

$$\langle DJ(\mathbf{m}) | \delta \mathbf{m} \rangle \approx J(\mathbf{m} + \delta \mathbf{m}) - J(\mathbf{m}).$$

Approximation of derivative relative to an **n-dimensional model parametrisation** requires **n+1 forward calculations**

One gradient calculation using this method for a realistic problem would take of order hundreds of years on a massive HPC system!

The **adjoint method** provides the exact gradient at a cost of **two forward simulations**

PDE constrained optimisation

We want to minimise:

$$J = \frac{1}{2} \int_0^T ||\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - \mathbf{u}^{obs}(t)||^2 dt,$$

subject to the constraints:

$$\rho \frac{\partial^2 u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) = -\frac{\partial \bar{S}_{ij}}{\partial x_j},$$

$$A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} \hat{n}_j = \bar{S}_{ij} \hat{n}_j$$

This can be done using the **method of Lagrange multipliers**

PDE constrained optimisation

We start by defining the **Lagrangian**:

$$L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) = J(\mathbf{u}) - \int_0^T \int_M \left[\rho \frac{\partial^2 u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} - \bar{S}_{ij} \right) \right] u'_i d^3 \mathbf{x} dt \\ - \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} - \bar{S}_{ij} \right) \hat{n}_j w'_i dS dt.$$

Each constraint is associated with a **Lagrange multiplier field**

Zero initial conditions on displacement and velocity are being imposed directly

Within the Lagrangian, all fields are regarded as being independent

Lagrange multiplier theorem

The following equality holds:

$$DJ(\mathbf{m}) = D_{\mathbf{m}}L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}),$$

so long as the following conditions are met:

$$D_{\mathbf{u}}L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) = 0,$$

$$D_{\mathbf{u}'}L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) = 0,$$

$$D_{\mathbf{w}'}L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) = 0.$$

Subscripts used for partial functional derivatives

You only need to know how to apply this method **not to prove** that it works – details provided in an appendix to the handout for anyone interested

The forward problem

Recall that the Lagrangian is:

$$\begin{aligned} L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) = & J(\mathbf{u}) - \int_0^T \int_M \left[\rho \frac{\partial^2 u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} - \bar{S}_{ij} \right) \right] u'_i d^3 \mathbf{x} dt \\ & - \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} - \bar{S}_{ij} \right) \hat{n}_j w'_i dS dt. \end{aligned}$$

Stationarity condition wrt to $\mathbf{u}'$ gives the equations of motion

Stationary conditions wrt to $\mathbf{w}'$ give the boundary conditions

This is how the forward problem emerges within the method

The adjoint problem

Varying wrt to $\mathbf{u}$ gives:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle D_{\mathbf{u}}L(\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{u}', \mathbf{w}', \mathbf{m}) | \delta \mathbf{u} \rangle &= \langle DJ(\mathbf{u}) | \delta \mathbf{u} \rangle - \int_0^T \int_M \left[\rho \frac{\partial^2 \delta u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial \delta u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \right] u'_i \, d^3 \mathbf{x} dt \\ &\quad - \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial \delta u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \hat{n}_j w'_i \, dS \, dt, \end{aligned}$$

From the chosen form for J we can write:

$$\langle DJ(\mathbf{u}) | \delta \mathbf{u} \rangle = \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} h'_i \delta u_i \, dS \, dt,$$

$$h'_i(\mathbf{x}, t) = [u_i(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - u_i^{obs}(t)] \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_r).$$

The adjoint problem

We need the following condition to hold:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} h'_i \delta u_i \, dS \, dt - \int_0^T \int_M \left[\rho \frac{\partial^2 \delta u_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial \delta u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \right] u'_i \, d^3 \mathbf{x} \, dt \\ - \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial \delta u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \hat{n}_j w'_i \, dS \, dt = 0, \end{aligned}$$

For all variations of the displacement vector

To see the consequence, we need to pass all the derivatives to the other terms using integration by parts in time and the divergence theorem spatially

Full details are in the handout

The adjoint problem

The result of the long calculation is that:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & - \int_0^T \int_M \left[\rho \frac{\partial^2 u'_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u'_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \right] \delta u_i \, d^3 \mathbf{x} \, dt \\
 & - \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial \delta u_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \hat{n}_j (w'_i - u'_i) \, dS \, dt \\
 & + \int_0^T \int_{\partial M} \left[h'_i - \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u'_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \hat{n}_j \right] \delta u_i \, dS \, dt \\
 & - \int_M \rho \left\{ \left[\frac{\partial \delta u_i}{\partial t} u'_i \right]_{t=T} - \left[\delta u_i \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial t} \right]_{t=T} \right\} d^3 \mathbf{x} = 0,
 \end{aligned}$$

From this we can read off the necessary adjoint equations

The adjoint problem

We have shown that the Lagrange multipliers must satisfy the equations:

$$\rho \frac{\partial^2 u'_i}{\partial t^2} - \frac{\partial}{\partial x_j} \left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u'_k}{\partial x_l} \right) = 0.$$

$$\left(A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u'_k}{\partial x_l} \right) \hat{n}_j = h'_i, \quad u'_i(\mathbf{x}, T) = \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial t}(\mathbf{x}, T) = 0.$$

along with the equality $\mathbf{u}' = \mathbf{w}'$ on the boundary

This is a **terminal-value problem** for $\mathbf{u}'$ driven by the boundary traction $\mathbf{h}'$:

$$h'_i(\mathbf{x}, t) = [u_i(\mathbf{x}_r, t) - u_i^{obs}(t)] \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_r).$$

Sensitivity kernels

Using the multiplier theorem and integrating by parts, we find that:

$$\langle DJ(\mathbf{m})|\delta\mathbf{m}\rangle = \int_0^T \int_M \left[\delta\rho \frac{\partial u_i}{\partial t} \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial t} - \delta A_{ijkl} \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial x_j} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} + \delta \bar{S}_{ij} \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial x_j} \right] d^3\mathbf{x} dt,$$

We can then read-off the sensitivity kernels:

$$\begin{aligned} K_\rho &= \int_0^T \frac{\partial u_i}{\partial t} \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial t} dt, \\ K_{A_{ijkl}} &= - \int_0^T \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial x_j} \frac{\partial u_k}{\partial x_l} dt, \\ K_{\bar{S}_{ij}} &= \frac{\partial u'_i}{\partial x_j}. \end{aligned}$$

Summary of the adjoint method

For each gradient calculation we must:

- 1) Solve the forward problem for $\mathbf{u}$
- 2) From this solution, compute J , and form the adjoint traction $\mathbf{h}'$
- 3) Solve the adjoint problem for $\mathbf{u}'$
- 4) Combine the forward and adjoint fields to form the sensitivity kernels

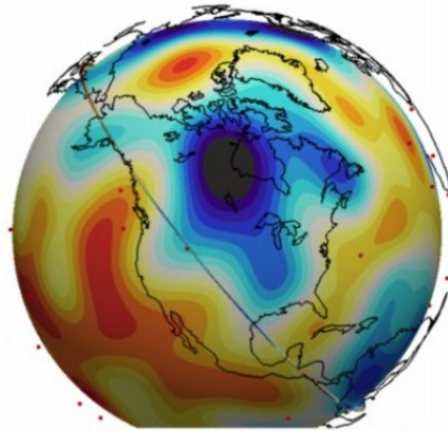
Such a calculation has the cost of two forward calculations

Adjoint equation near identical to the forward one, and so the same numerical code can be used with only minor modification

Choice of misfit enters into the problem only through the form of the adjoint traction

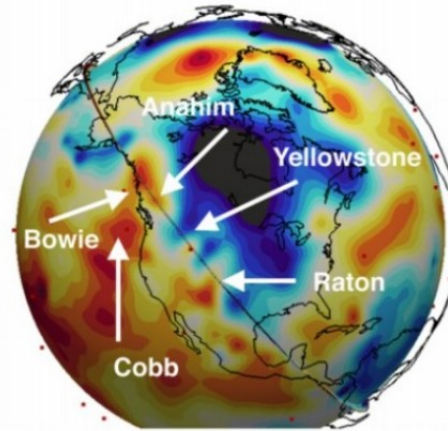
Calculations that would take hundred of years reduced to a minutes or hours

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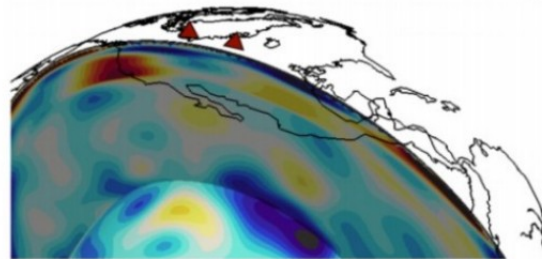
$d\ln V_{sv}$ (2%)
min max

GLAD-M15



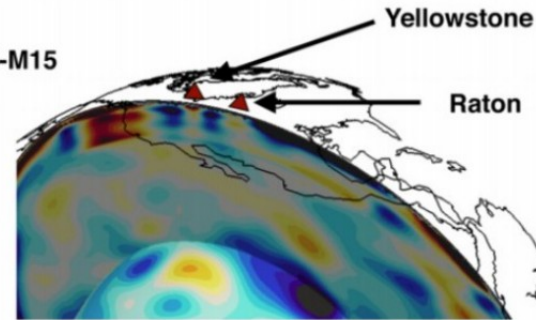
$d\ln V_{sv}$ (2%)
min max

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$d\ln V_{sv}$ (2%)
min max

GLAD-M15



$d\ln V_{sv}$ (2%)
min max

Banana doughnut kernels

In practice, delay times are measured using **cross-correlations**:

$$C(\tau) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} s^{obs}(t - \tau) s(\mathbf{x}_s, t) dt.$$

Time-shift that maximises the **cross-correlation** taken as the delay time

This defines a functional of the synthetic waveform, and hence we can derive the associated sensitivity kernels using the adjoint method

The only step we haven't covered is determining the adjoint traction for this choice of functional – this is an easy calculation, but not one you need to know

